

# Disaster recovery

**THE WORLD IS IN TURMOIL AS I WRITE THIS,** and we're all in lockdown all over the globe. It's amazing how a nanoscale virus is what brought the world to its knees – something we never expected to happen. We were arrogant and complacent, and have brought this on ourselves by disrespecting nature, but that's a rabbit hole I'd rather not go down.

Instead, I'd rather focus on Digit, and relive some of the disasters we have come through over the years, with our much loved readers by our side. And try and find a way to recover from this one as well.

I still remember the morning of July 26, 2005 like it was yesterday. I used to bike the 30 km to work (from Mumbai to Navi Mumbai) back in those days, and though the rain was heavy for late July, unseasonal rain was something we were used to as Mumbaikars. We'd just finished the August issue a couple of days earlier, and 26th was usually the time we had all-day meetings planning the stories of the next issue. In those days we were housed in a 77,000 sq ft building, and the Digit conference room was about half the size of our current Mumbai office. About 15 of us were in the room, wildly discussing ideas and how we could approach stories. These meetings usually went on for 8 to 10 hours, so there were several bathroom breaks taken, and every time we emerged for one, the faces of the others in the office seemed to be getting more and more concerned. We'd all seen heavy rain before, but this was just insane levels, and people were rightly concerned.

Then at some time in the afternoon, people rushed into the conference room to tell us Digit was in trouble. This building had a basement, and that's where all of Digit's components were brought in and assembled by the packing staff, and then sealed in subscriber copies or in newsstand copies – DVDs, Fast Track, main mag, etc. The basement had started flooding and all power was turned off, people smashed windows and were bailing water outside with buckets, and chaos ensued. Needless to say a few of us jumped into the water to help out, but were promptly chased out by the production staff. "We've got this, we can manage. You need to stay safe so you can make the next issue."

A few years earlier, there had been a horrible car accident that killed some of our production and circulation employees who were out on

field work. This was still raw, and haunted our production and circulation staff, who had made it a point to not travel in large groups together, or in this case, allow us editorial folk to help with anything dangerous. That was the Digit way. Even in emergencies people were thinking about the future, about the next issue, about goals still to be achieved. Very few of those people remain at the company today, but I still remember how tirelessly they bailed out water, and carried heavy stacks of magazines on their backs out of the rooms they had sandbagged to protect from the rising water. That wasn't their job. That was just their nature. All of those same people also worked hard to get that August 2005 issue to the railway stations, braving flooded roads and worse to send those magazines out to the rest of India.

Now, a little under 15 years later, I sit here in my room at home, isolated from the world. Every member of Team Digit is doing the same. Not because we are scared the virus will hurt us, but because we are scared the virus will hurt others. We have finished the April 2020 issue (this is the last thing being written), but there is no way to get the magazine out to you. This is not one of those times where bravery saves us... it is a time when being smart saves us all.

However, we're not content to sit here on our butts and do nothing, throwing our hands up in the air and claiming helplessness. That's not the Digit way, after all.

We wanted to make sure that you get to read your favourite magazine from a PC or mobile device during this lockdown. We want to make sure that everyone who has subscribed or bought the magazine online still gets access within the first week of the month. We want to make sure that those who get their monthly fix from a newsstand can also read Digit.

Just head to <https://geek.digit.in> and follow the instructions there to read your favourite magazine, while we work out how to send your physical copy to you. Buying the physical copy either via subscription or a single issue purchase from store.digit.in gives you access to this digital version. We've also added a cheaper, digital only access option, which you can purchase from [geek.digit.in](https://geek.digit.in).

I hope you will support us with this, and be understanding of the delays in getting your physical copy to you. Please stay safe, and Team Digit sends you and your families much love through these tough times. 🇮🇳



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